

STARTER

Common Refusal Reasons & How to Avoid Them

Germany - Schengen Tourist Visa (Type C)

German Schengen visa refusals use the same standardised EU-wide refusal form as other Schengen states, listing the specific ground(s) checked under Annex VI of the Visa Code. German missions are commonly noted for expecting thorough, well-organised documentation, since most applications are decided without an interview.

The most common specific reasons

1. Incomplete or informal Verpflichtungserklärung

If you're relying on a personal host, a casual letter instead of the formal Verpflichtungserklärung your host obtains from their local Ausländerbehörde is a common, avoidable gap - the two are not interchangeable.

2. Insufficient means of subsistence

- Show funds proportionate to your stated trip length and plans, not just a single snapshot balance
- If your host's Verpflichtungserklärung covers your costs, that substitutes for personal financial evidence for the amount it covers

3. Doubts about your intention to leave before your visa expires

The consulate isn't convinced you're a genuine short-stay visitor who will leave before your authorised stay ends.

- Evidence ties at home: employment, family, property, or ongoing study
- Keep your itinerary specific and consistent throughout the application

4. Missing or insufficient travel medical insurance

Insurance must meet the Schengen minimum coverage, for the whole Schengen area and your full trip - missing or inadequate cover is a specific, standardised refusal ground on its own.

5. Applying at the wrong consulate

If Germany isn't your main destination or first point of entry, your application can be refused or redirected - confirm which Schengen state's consulate is actually responsible for your itinerary before applying.

REMONSTRATION BEFORE COURT

Germany has its own specific first step after a refusal: a Remonstrationsverfahren, an internal objection you file directly with the same consulate, asking them to reconsider. This is separate from, and comes before, any judicial appeal. See the Refusal Decision Guide (Premium tier) for how this works.